AI BUSINESS EXPERT — INTERNAL INTELLIGENCE SERIES

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Intelligent Automation Is Delivering **Measurable Returns** — But Only for Organisations That Did the Hard Work First

A research-based analysis of verified intelligent automation outcomes across financial services, manufacturing, logistics, and telecoms — with specific before/after evidence and functional application ideas.

£60M
INVESTOR-DISCLOSED SAVINGS — AVIVA

3.9M
HOURS SAVED BY IBM IN 2024 ALONE

6%
OF ORGANISATIONS ATTRIBUTE >5% EBIT TO AI (MCKINSEY 2025)

55%
OF HIGH PERFORMERS REDESIGNED PROCESSES *BEFORE* DEPLOYING

AI BUSINESS EXPERT
Intelligence Pipeline · Article 001

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27 sources · 9 verification gates · Grade: A

INTERNAL This document is prepared for internal circulation. All claims are sourced to verified research. Confidence levels are noted where relevant.

Why This Matters Right Now

JPMorgan has been processing 12,000 commercial loan agreements annually through its COiN system since 2017 — work that previously consumed 360,000 legal and loan officer hours per year. That is not a projection or a pilot result. It is eight years of verified operational reality.

While many organisations are still debating whether intelligent automation is ready for serious deployment, a cohort of enterprises has moved past debate into scale, and the distance between them and the field is widening.

What the Research Shows

The evidence base across financial services, manufacturing, logistics, and telecoms is now substantive enough to draw clear conclusions — not about AI in the abstract, but about specific tools, specific companies, and specific problems that were genuinely broken before.

At Aviva, manual claims liability assessment was inconsistent and slow — complex cases took weeks longer than necessary, routing errors sent claims to the wrong specialisms, and complaint volumes were high. After deploying 80 AI models in partnership with McKinsey QuantumBlack, the insurer reduced complex liability assessment time by 23 days per case, improved routing accuracy by 30%, and cut customer complaints by 65%. The documented savings of £60 million (approximately AU$115 million) are investor-disclosed — the highest-confidence single-organisation ROI figure in the research base.

IBM's Client Zero programme deployed 155 AI use cases across HR, IT, procurement, finance, and sales — using its own 175-country operation as the test environment. IBM's AskIT reduced standard IT support tickets by 56% between 2022 and 2024, with 86% of IT queries now resolved without human involvement. AskHR resolves 94% of HR queries autonomously. IBM states US$4.5 billion in annual run-rate productivity savings — IBM-stated rather than independently audited, but reflecting 3.9 million hours saved in 2024 alone.

88%	6%	50%	55%
DEPLOY AI IN AT LEAST ONE FUNCTION	ATTRIBUTE >5% OF EBIT TO AI	OF INITIAL RPA PROJECTS FAIL	OF AI HIGH PERFORMERS REDESIGNED PROCESSES FIRST
McKinsey State of AI 2025, n=1,993	*McKinsey State of AI 2025*	*Ernst & Young research*	*McKinsey State of AI 2025*

THE FAILURE PICTURE — EQUALLY CLEAR

Ernst & Young research found that up to 50% of initial RPA projects fail — not due to technology limitations, but due to wrong process selection, insufficient change management, and underestimating bot fragility when application interfaces change. McKinsey's November 2025 State of AI survey (n=1,993) found that while 88% of organisations deploy AI in at least one function, only 6% can attribute more than 5% of EBIT to AI. Adoption is widespread; value is concentrated.

The Business Value — Translated

A vendor-commissioned Forrester Total Economic Impact study on SS&C Blue Prism modelled a US$4 billion revenue financial services organisation achieving a 330% three-year ROI and US$53.4 million NPV, with customer onboarding cut from 16–18 days to 2 days and payback under six months. This is a composite model and should be read as directional — but the underlying drivers (labour cost reduction, cycle time compression, error rate improvement) are the same mechanisms visible in named-company results.

For mid-to-large enterprises at the early-to-mid adoption stage, three realistic value mechanisms are well-evidenced:

Labour Deflection	Quality Improvement	Cycle Time Compression
IT SUPPORT, CLAIMS TRIAGE, DOCUMENT REVIEW	REDUCED ROUTING ERRORS, AUTOMATED COMPLIANCE	CX IMPROVEMENT AND WORKING CAPITAL BENEFITS

55%

of AI high performers fundamentally redesigned underlying processes before deploying automation — nearly three times the rate of other organisations. Process redesign takes time. Organisations that begin that diagnostic work now will reach deployable process designs months ahead of those who wait for technology maturity. — *McKinsey State of AI, November 2025*

Gartner projects that 40% of enterprise applications will feature embedded AI agents by end of 2026, up from less than 5% in 2025 — meaning the AI capability in platforms your organisation already owns (Salesforce, ServiceNow, Microsoft 365) will expand materially over the next 12 months regardless of whether you actively deploy it.

Application Ideas by Function

The table below maps the most evidence-backed automation opportunities to specific functions, with a concrete first step for each. Every tool and outcome cited is sourced to verified research.

FUNCTION	SPECIFIC AI APPLICATION & EVIDENCE	FIRST STEP (30–90 DAYS)
Operations & Supply Chain	**Siemens AI-driven predictive analytics** — sensor monitoring and ML to flag equipment failure before breakdown. Results: 50% reduction in unplanned stoppages, 45% less unplanned downtime, 28% lower maintenance spend.	Identify two or three critical assets where failure causes the greatest production disruption. Assess whether current sensor data is captured and stored in a format accessible to a predictive maintenance model. If not, that is the investment to make before any software procurement.
Finance & Risk	**JPMorgan COiN / Harvey / Luminance / Litera Kira** — contract intelligence for first-pass document review. COiN eliminated 360,000 lawyer hours per year. Comparable tools now available without proprietary fine-tuning investment.	Commission a half-day scoping session with legal operations or in-house legal to map which contract review workflows consume the greatest volume of lawyer time and would benefit most from AI-assisted first-pass review.
Customer Experience	**Salesforce Einstein Service Cloud** — Iron Mountain deployed to eliminate multi-application context switching. Results: 80% of cases closed via AI-generated responses, 76% sent unedited, chat abandonment 5% → 1.5%. *(Salesforce case study — indicative)*	If your organisation uses Salesforce Service Cloud, request a briefing on Einstein AI features already included in your licence tier. Many organisations are not activating capabilities they have already paid for.
Human Resources & Talent	**IBM watsonx AskHR / Bank of America Erica (internal)** — autonomous HR query resolution. IBM: 94% HR query autonomy, 75% ticket reduction. BofA: >50% IT desk call reduction across 213,000 staff; developers >20% productivity gain.	Analyse your HR help desk ticket volume for the past 12 months, segment by query type, and identify the top five repeating question categories. These are the highest-value targets for a conversational AI deployment — well-bounded, high-frequency, and low-risk.
IT & Infrastructure	**Dynatrace AIOps / ServiceNow Now Assist** — BT Group/Openreach: self-healing systems reduced repair volume 10%, energy 4%, on track for £28M cumulative saving by 2027. ASML: >80% user satisfaction within weeks on Now Assist.	Pull your current IT service desk ticket data and identify the top ten ticket categories by volume. Request a vendor briefing from your ServiceNow or ITSM account team specifically on AI deflection capability available on your current contract.

What to Watch

01 **Platform AI agent embedding (end of 2026).** Gartner projects 40% of enterprise applications will have embedded AI agents by end of 2026, up from less than 5% in 2025. This is a product roadmap signal from Salesforce, ServiceNow, SAP, and Microsoft — it should inform your current platform renewal and licensing decisions, not just your AI strategy.

02 **EU AI Act enforcement begins.** Now in full effect, with penalties up to €35 million or 7% of global revenue for non-compliant high-risk AI systems in credit, employment, and insurance. For organisations with EU exposure, this is a direct, quantifiable cost of non-compliance — no longer hypothetical.

03 **Agentic AI cancellation rate.** Forrester predicts fewer than 15% of firms will activate agentic automation features by end of 2026. Gartner puts cancellation risk above 40% of fully autonomous agentic projects by 2027. The lower-risk near-term path is AI-assisted deterministic workflows — not fully autonomous multi-step agents.

Suggested Internal Next Steps

1. **Commission a process diagnostic session** with your Operations and Finance leads — ideally half a day — to map the five highest-volume, most repetitive processes each function manages. Cross-reference against Celonis process mining or your current ERP's native analytics to identify where those processes deviate, loop, or break. This is the prerequisite work that McKinsey identifies as the differentiator between high-performing and average automation programmes.

2. **Request AI feature briefings from your existing platform vendors** — Salesforce, ServiceNow, or Microsoft 365 account teams — specifically on AI features available within your current licence agreements, before your next renewal cycle. Many organisations are paying for AI capability they have not activated. Prioritise activation of existing tools over new platform procurement.

3. **Assign one named person** in IT or a governance function to map which existing automation programmes — including any RPA bots already running — have documented measurement frameworks in place. Gartner found fewer than 20% of companies excel at measuring hyperautomation effectiveness. Without measurement, you cannot make evidence-based decisions about where to continue, scale, or retire automation investment.

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